MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DevOps / Platform Engineering | CI/CD & Test Infrastructure

Wroclaw, Poland | marta.kowalbrandt@example.com | +48 555 303 303 | gitlab.com/mkb-example

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including 2 years owning CI/CD and test infrastructure for three product teams. Professional experience includes GitLab CI, Docker, Helm, namespace-level Kubernetes deployments, ephemeral environments and observability tooling. Personal infrastructure work includes a k3s homelab, Argo CD, Terraform-provisioned Hetzner VPS infrastructure and Prometheus/Grafana/Loki. Strong in automation, analytical pipeline optimisation, technical documentation and cross-team enablement; transitioning into a full-time platform engineering role.

Selected Strengths: Analytical approach demonstrated through pipeline profiling, a 63% pipeline-time reduction, flaky-test analysis and CI workflow documentation used for onboarding.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure & CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Terraform (personal Hetzner infrastructure project), Argo CD

Infrastructure as code: Terraform (personal Hetzner project); Helm

Containers & platforms: Kubernetes (namespace-level deployments), k3s, Linux

Observability and certificate management: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, cert-manager, TLS

Monitoring & data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL

Languages & scripting: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL

Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman

Other: Git, Ansible (basic), AWS: EC2 and S3 fundamentals (personal learning)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw *2021–Present*

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (~25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end testing; the improvement also reduced monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.
- Built short-lived, per-merge-request test environments with Docker Compose and later Helm on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster. Environments include the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data; they are removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Built Python tooling that collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and exposed flaky-test metrics through Grafana dashboards.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding.
- Authored an internal guide to how the CI system works, used in team onboarding; mentored two QA interns in 2023.
- Owned CI/CD improvements across three product teams (~25 developers), documenting the CI workflow for onboarding and enabling QA and product teams to review features in per-merge-request environments.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw *2019–2021*

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd Line) | Brightmill Software House *2018–2019*

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECT

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal *2024–2025*

- Set up a three-node k3s cluster on Raspberry Pi 5 devices, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Configured Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS certificate management.
- Provisioned a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform and used basic Ansible configuration; this was personal infrastructure work, not production company cloud infrastructure.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam scheduled for January 2027

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)